

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 9

Group 9 Vocabulary

1. Boorish

Meaning: Rude, insensitive, and socially awkward.

Tip to remember: Boorish sounds like “boring and rude.” A boorish person behaves badly in public.

Sentence: His boorish comments offended everyone at the dinner.

2. Brook

Meaning: To tolerate or allow something, usually used in the negative.

Tip to remember: Think of a strict teacher saying, “I will brook no excuses.” It means the teacher will tolerate no excuses.

Sentence: The manager would brook no delay in the project.

3. Circumspect

Meaning: Careful and cautious before acting.

Tip to remember: “Circum” means around, and “spect” means look. Circumspect means looking around carefully before deciding.

Sentence: A good engineer must be circumspect when designing safety systems.

4. Comity

Meaning: Mutual respect, courtesy, and peaceful cooperation.

Tip to remember: Comity sounds like “community.” A good community needs respect and cooperation.

Sentence: The two countries maintained comity despite political differences.

5. Commensurate

Meaning: Equal or proportional in size, amount, or degree.

Tip to remember: Think of “common measure.” If two things are commensurate, they match in measure.

Sentence: His salary was commensurate with his experience.

6. Cordial

Meaning: Warm, friendly, and polite.

Tip to remember: Cordial sounds like “core of heart.” A cordial person speaks warmly from the heart.

Sentence: The professor gave us a cordial welcome.

7. **Deleterious**
Meaning: Harmful or damaging.
Tip to remember: Deleterious sounds like “delete.” Something deleterious deletes health, progress, or quality.
Sentence: Air pollution has deleterious effects on human health.
8. **Dichotomy**
Meaning: A division between two opposite or very different things.
Tip to remember: “Di” means two. Dichotomy means a split into two parts.
Sentence: The lecture discussed the dichotomy between theory and practice.
9. **Edify**
Meaning: To educate, improve, or morally uplift someone.
Tip to remember: Edify sounds like “educate.” To edify is to educate or improve the mind.
Sentence: The book was written to edify young readers.
10. **Elicit**
Meaning: To draw out a response, answer, or reaction.
Tip to remember: Elicit sounds like “extract.” You elicit information by drawing it out.
Sentence: The teacher asked questions to elicit ideas from the students.
11. **Erudite**
Meaning: Very learned and knowledgeable.
Tip to remember: Think of an erudite professor surrounded by books and ideas.
Sentence: Her erudite explanation impressed the entire class.
12. **Fecund**
Meaning: Highly fertile or very productive.
Tip to remember: Think of fertile soil producing many crops. Fecund means productive.
Sentence: The scientist had a fecund imagination and proposed many new ideas.
13. **Feeble**
Meaning: Weak or lacking strength.
Tip to remember: Feeble sounds like “feel weak.” A feeble person or argument lacks power.
Sentence: His excuse was too feeble to convince the teacher.
14. **Felicitous**
Meaning: Well-chosen, suitable, or pleasing.
Tip to remember: Felicitous sounds like “felicity,” meaning happiness. A felicitous word or action fits well and makes people pleased.
Sentence: Her felicitous example made the difficult idea easy to understand.
15. **Forbear**
Meaning: To hold back from doing something; to show patience or self-control.

Tip to remember: Think of “forbear” as “bear it for now.” You tolerate the situation and control yourself.

Sentence: He decided to forbear from arguing with his rude classmate.

16. **Haphazard**

Meaning: Random, careless, and without proper planning.

Tip to remember: Think of work done by chance or hazard. Haphazard work has no clear plan.

Sentence: His haphazard study routine did not help him improve.

17. **Hodgepodge**

Meaning: A confused mixture of different things.

Tip to remember: Hodgepodge sounds messy. Imagine random items thrown into one box.

Sentence: The essay was a hodgepodge of unrelated ideas.

18. **Impede**

Meaning: To slow down, block, or obstruct progress.

Tip to remember: Impede sounds like “in pedal.” If something blocks your pedal, your bicycle slows down.

Sentence: Poor internet connection can impede online learning.

19. **Impetuous**

Meaning: Acting quickly without careful thought; impulsive.

Tip to remember: Impetuous sounds like “impulse.” An impetuous person acts on impulse.

Sentence: His impetuous decision caused many problems.

20. **Irascible**

Meaning: Easily angered; hot-tempered.

Tip to remember: Irascible sounds like “irritated.” An irascible person gets irritated quickly.

Sentence: The irascible boss shouted at employees for small mistakes.

21. **Mercenary**

Meaning: Motivated mainly by money; also, a soldier hired to fight for money.

Tip to remember: Mercenary sounds like “money mission.” A mercenary person acts for money, not principle.

Sentence: His mercenary attitude made people doubt his loyalty.

22. **Meticulous**

Meaning: Extremely careful and attentive to details.

Tip to remember: Think of a meticulous editor checking every comma and spelling.

Sentence: The engineer made a meticulous inspection of the circuit.

23. **Mordant**

Meaning: Sharply critical, biting, or sarcastic.

Tip to remember: Mordant words bite like acid. They are sharp and painful.

Sentence: His mordant humor made some people laugh and others uncomfortable.

24. **Outstrip**

Meaning: To surpass, exceed, or do better than.

Tip to remember: Think of a runner stripping ahead of others in a race. To outstrip means to go beyond.

Sentence: Demand for electricity may outstrip supply during peak hours.

25. **Precarious**

Meaning: Dangerous, unstable, or uncertain.

Tip to remember: Think of standing on a shaky bridge. That position is precarious.

Sentence: The old building was in a precarious condition.

26. **Quirky**

Meaning: Unusual in an interesting or strange way.

Tip to remember: A quirky person has little quirks, or odd habits, that make them unique.

Sentence: His quirky sense of humor made him popular among friends.

27. **Repudiate**

Meaning: To reject, deny, or refuse to accept something.

Tip to remember: Think of saying “reject publicly.” Repudiate means to strongly reject.

Sentence: The scientist repudiated the false claim about his research.

28. **Tact**

Meaning: Skill in saying or doing things without offending others.

Tip to remember: Think of touching a sensitive topic carefully. Tact means social carefulness.

Sentence: She handled the disagreement with great tact.

29. **Trifling**

Meaning: Unimportant or insignificant.

Tip to remember: Think of a tiny trifle dessert: small and not serious. Trifling means minor.

Sentence: They argued over a trifling issue.

30. **Turbulent**

Meaning: Chaotic, violent, or full of disturbance.

Tip to remember: Think of turbulence in an airplane. Turbulent situations are unstable and rough.

Sentence: The country went through a turbulent political period.